

UX Research Report: Global Conflict Tracker

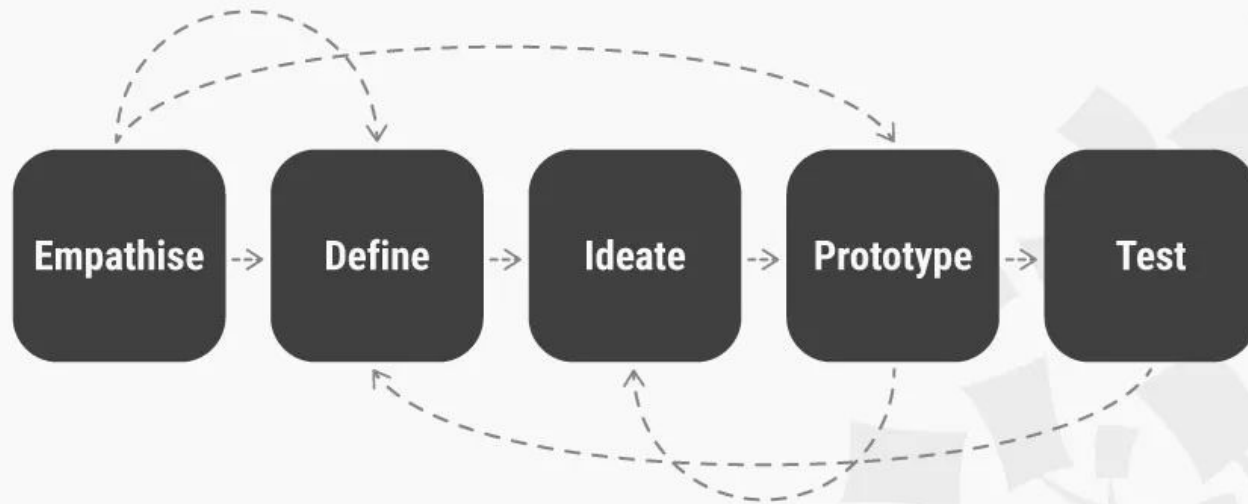
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Design Thinking: A 5 Stage Process



INTERACTION DESIGN
FOUNDATION

INTERACTION-DESIGN.ORG

Methods

Survey

Purpose: Assess who is already using the product, for what purpose, and how successful they were.

Focus Group

Purpose: Convene groups of people who align with the demographics represented in the survey results to understand how they understand the topic and what subcategories they associate with it.

Usability Testing

Purpose: Evaluate how users interact with the site to complete tasks. Tasks are directly aligned with the product's strategic goals and relate to existing or proposed design and functionality. Testing occurs with users who match the criteria found in the survey and/or with new target audiences.

Survey

Site Intercept Survey

- Two weeks (Mar 17-31)
- 100% of visitors
- All device types
- After 15 seconds and 20% scroll
- URLs containing /global-conflict-tracker

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What brought you to the Global Conflict Tracker today?

☐ I'm doing research with a specific goal in mind.

☐ I'm interested in this topic generally.

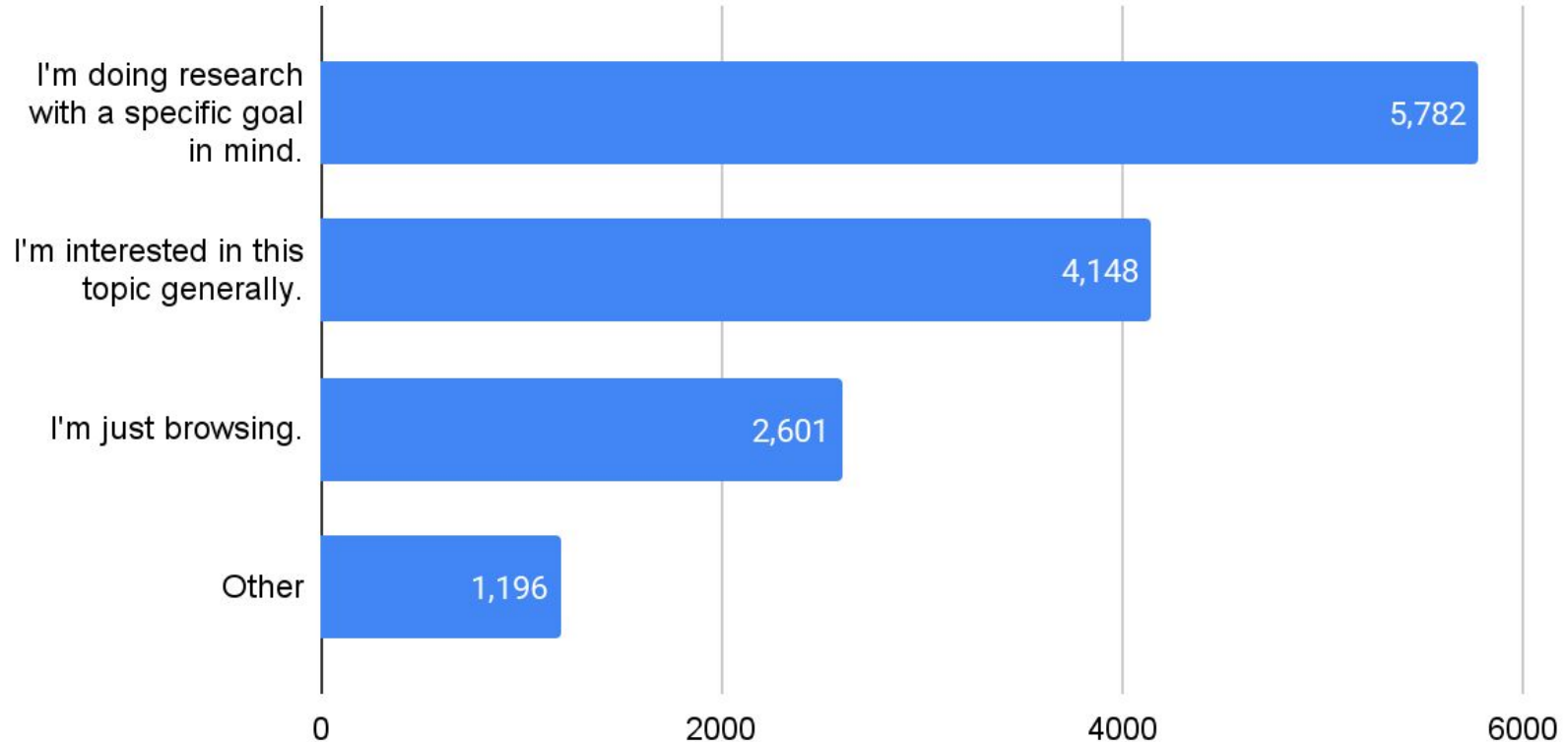
☐ I'm just browsing.

☐ Other

[>>](#)

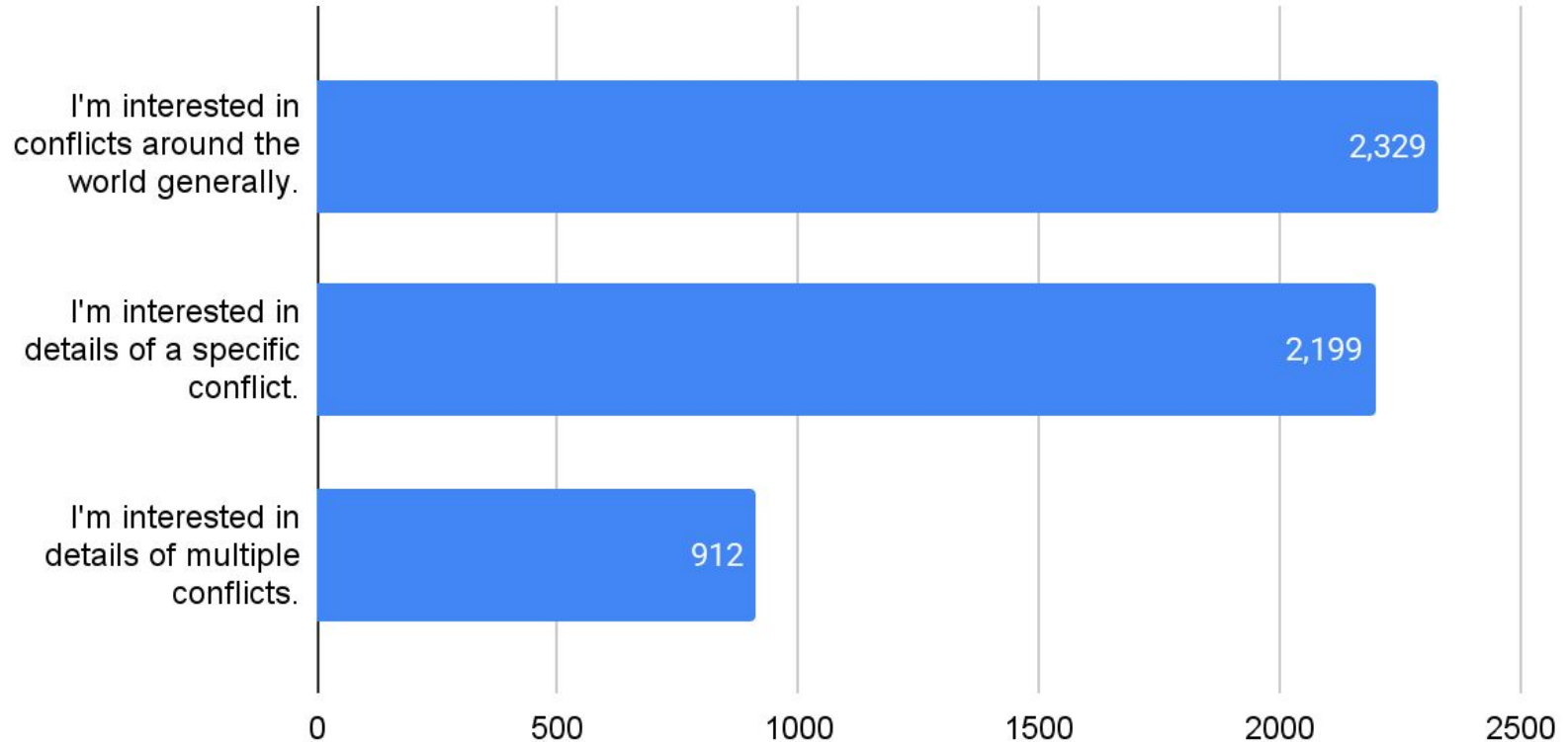
What brought you to the Global Conflict Tracker today?

13,727 responses



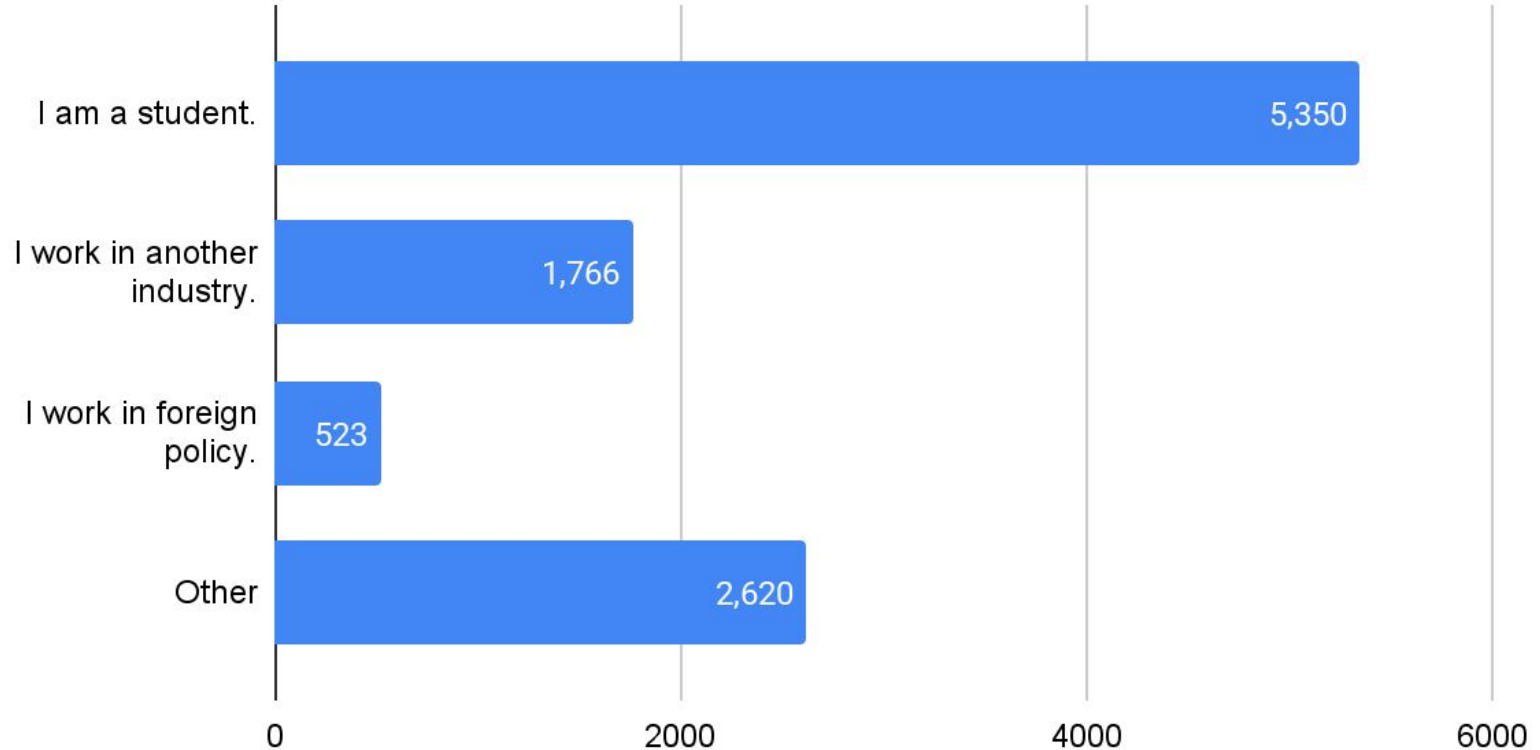
Which best describes your goal today?

5,440 responses



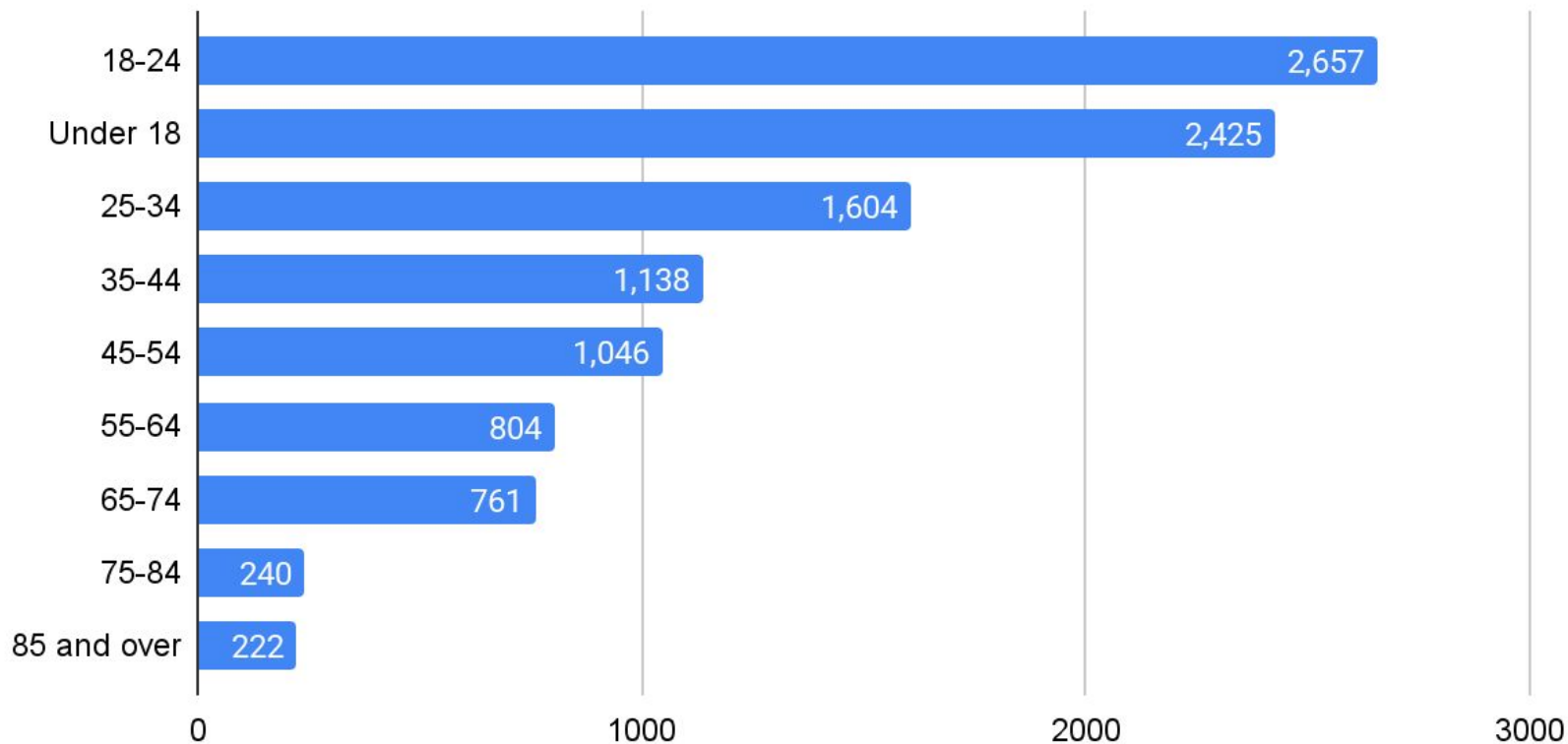
What is your profession?

10,260 responses



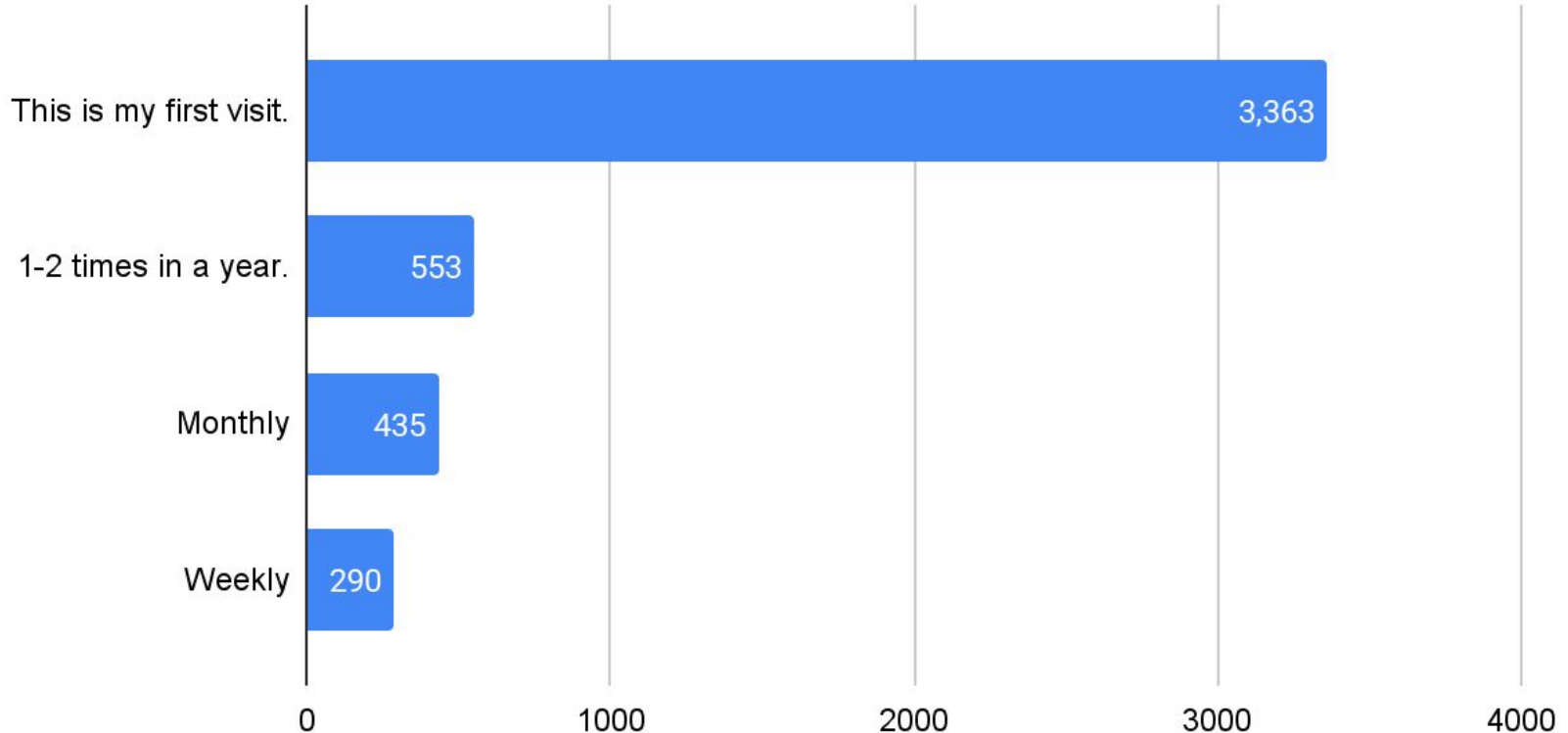
Please select your age range.

13,100 responses



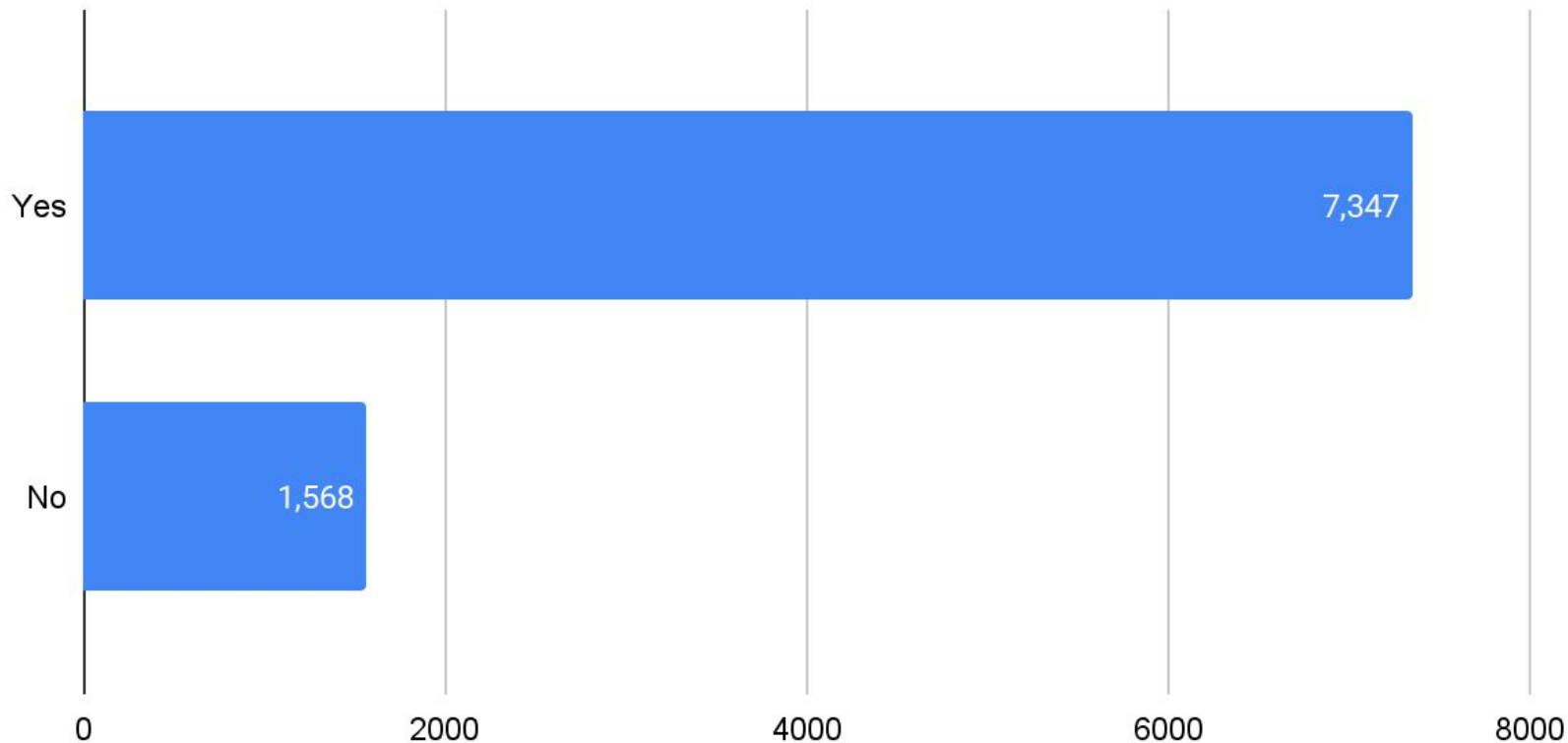
How often do you visit the Global Conflict Tracker?

4,642 responses



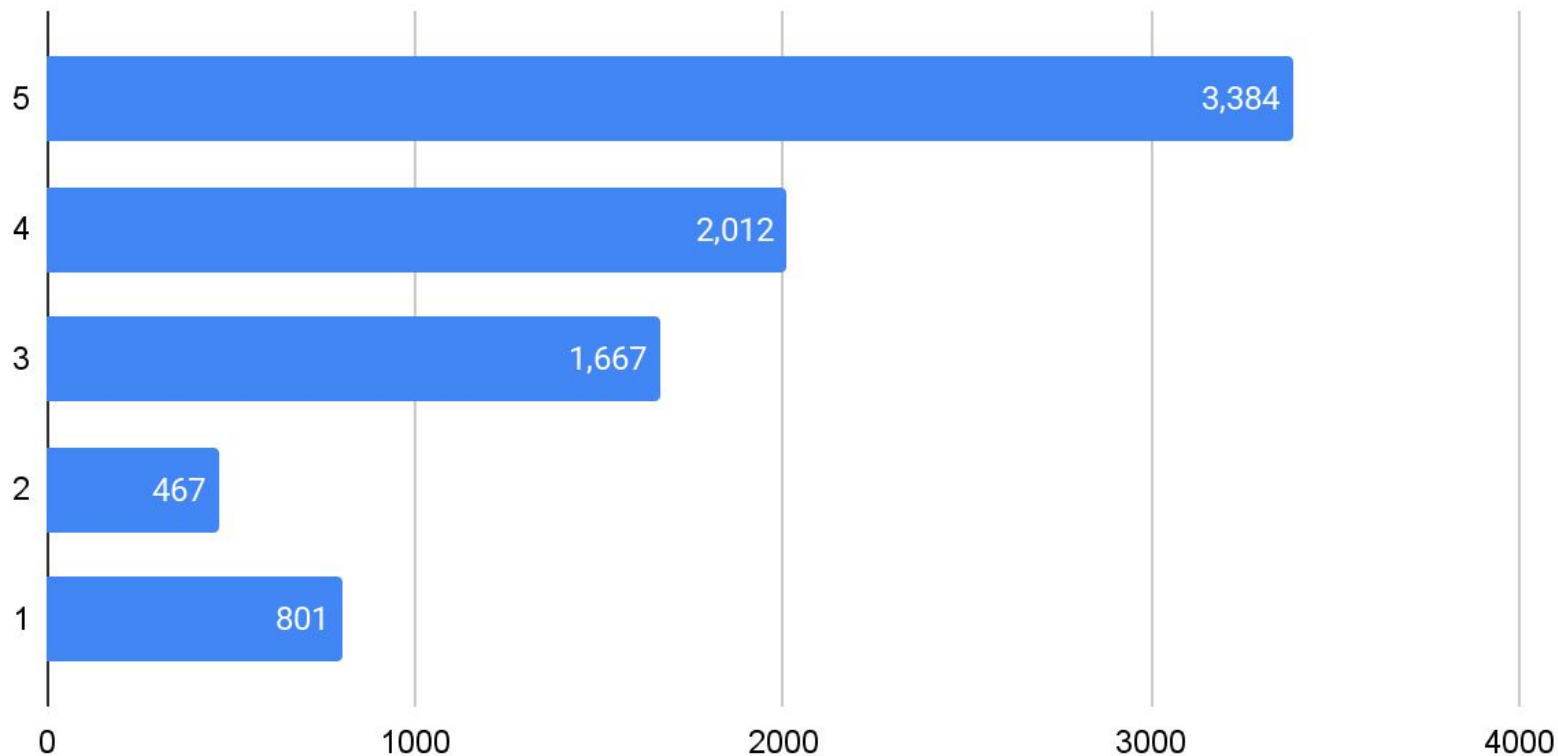
Did you find what you were looking for today?

8,915 responses



How easy was it to find what you were looking for?

8,331 responses



Country

Yemen

0.0%

Lithuania

0.4%

Poland

0.6%

South Africa

1.5%

Netherlands

1.5%

India

3.7%

Australia

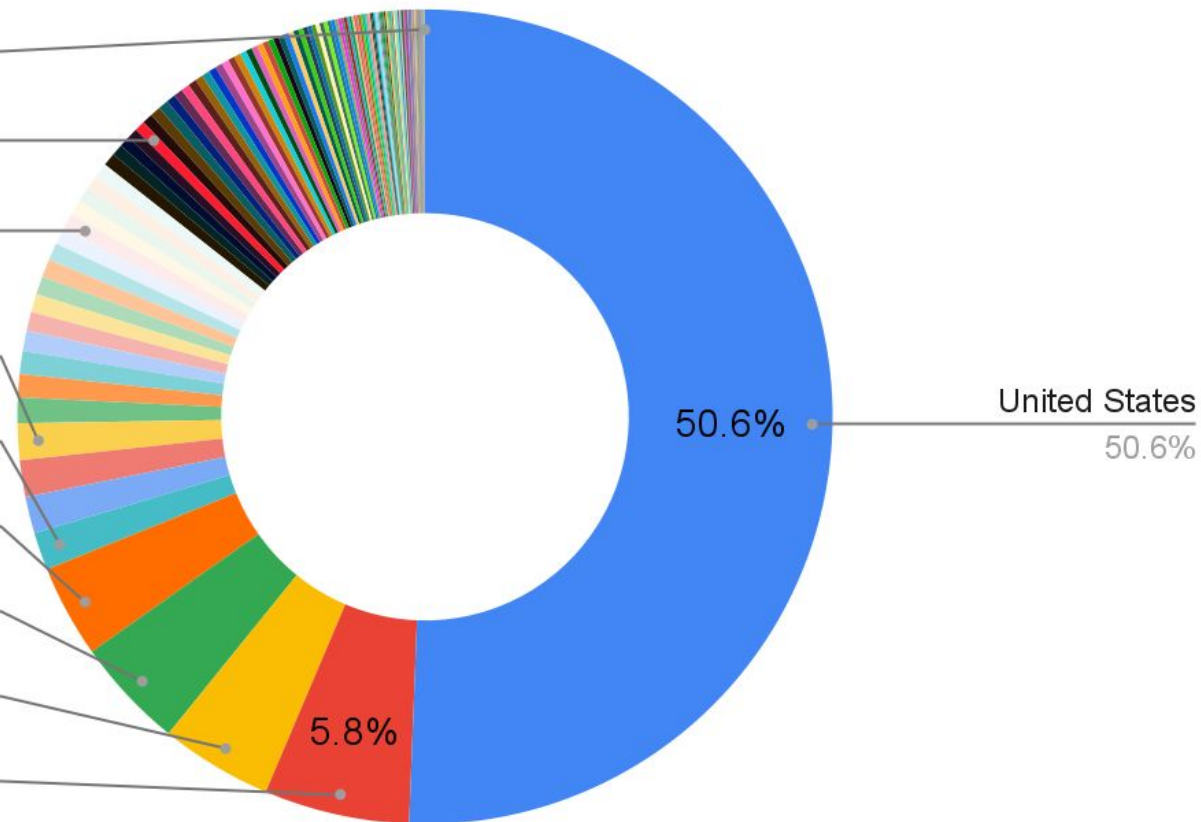
4.4%

Canada

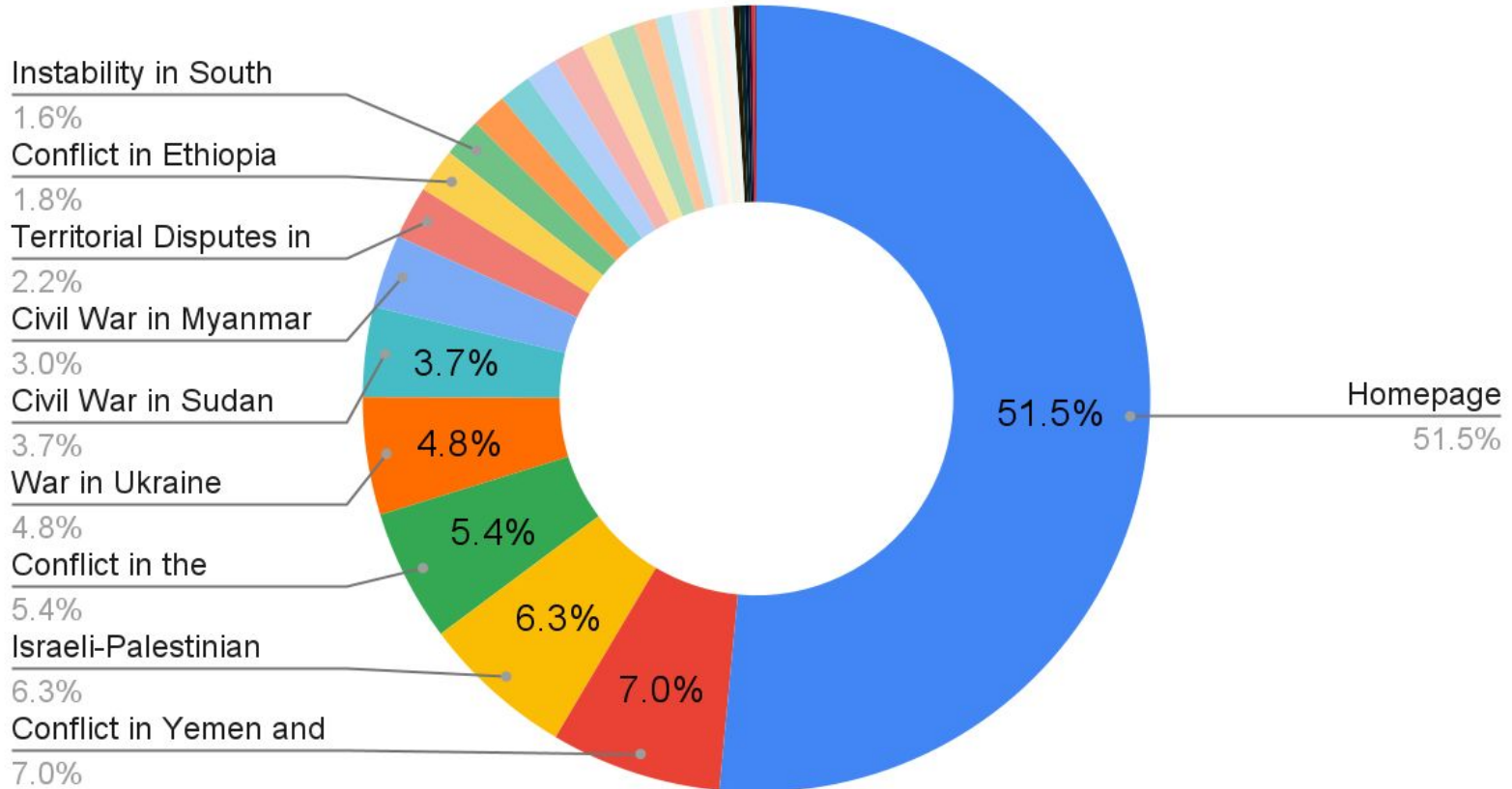
4.4%

United Kingdom

5.8%



Page



Survey Takeaways

- Students ages 24 and under continue to be primary user group
- Most are doing research
- New: Interest in global conflicts generally ranks first
 - ◆ Getting details of a specific conflict ranks second
- Top pages visited largely driven by news events
- Most users had a positive, successful experience
- Most are first-time users*
- Users based in English-speaking countries

Focus Groups

Recruitment & Process

- New York-based university students
- 18-24 years old
- Enrolled in political science or international affairs class
- Two groups of 5 and 6 students, respectively

1. How do you stay informed about current events?
2. What is a conflict?
3. What brings your attention to conflicts?
4. What do you do when you want to learn more about a conflict?
5. What types of conflict are there?
6. What is a status for a conflict?
7. What does “impact on the U.S.” mean?

Focus Group Findings

News and Information

- All media is biased
- Sources:
 - “Reliable sources” include NYT, AP, WaPo, Al Jazeera
 - Social media accounts (youtube, instagram, Tiktok)
 - Email (Newsletters and breaking news alerts)
- Tiktok is for opinions
- Personal connections (talking to friends, dinner table, ask “someone who knows a lot about it”)

Conflict

- There are various types of conflict
- There are degrees of conflict
- Human rights matter - “people shouldn’t die”
- Violence, injustice, and U.S. involvement draws their attention to a conflict
- Conflicts don’t have much direct impact on participants’ personal lives
- Russia-Ukraine and Israel-Palestine are top of mind, China was never mentioned
- Lack of a sense of historical/global context

Usability Testing

Recruitment

Testing

- Trial account with [usertesting.com](https://www.usertesting.com)
- 10 participants (5 desktop, 5 mobile)

Screenener

- First time GCT users
- Students

Demographic

- Age range: 21 - 23 years old
- 6 Female, 4 Male
- United States

Testing Process

Users were recruited and asked to complete tasks that we designed for them

- 11 tasks total
- 7 - 16 minutes to complete all tasks

Focused on:

Homepage (GCT Map)

- Map & Tooltip
- Search & Filter

Conflict Pages

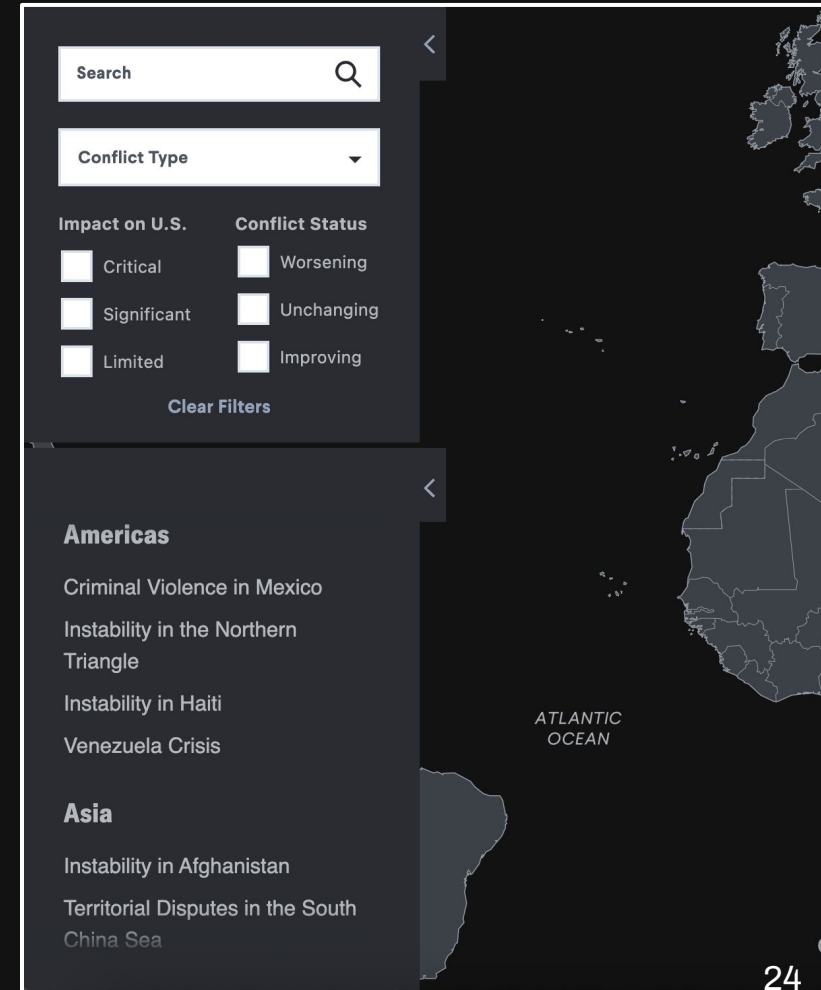
Homepage

- Global Conflict Tracker homepage/map was clear on first impression
- All users interacted with the map
 - 8 out of 10 users utilized the map first when trying to find Yemen
- 4 out of 5 mobile users swiped up on the drawer expecting more information on conflict
- Only 2 people (desktop) used the list of conflicts to complete a task
- Issue with tooltip on desktop not displaying near conflict



Homepage

- Users initially had trouble finding the search and filter functions on mobile and desktop
 - All users eventually found the filters option
- Users had trouble clearing filters
- Related territories in a conflict not shown in search result



Conflict Page

Latest News module ignored on Mobile

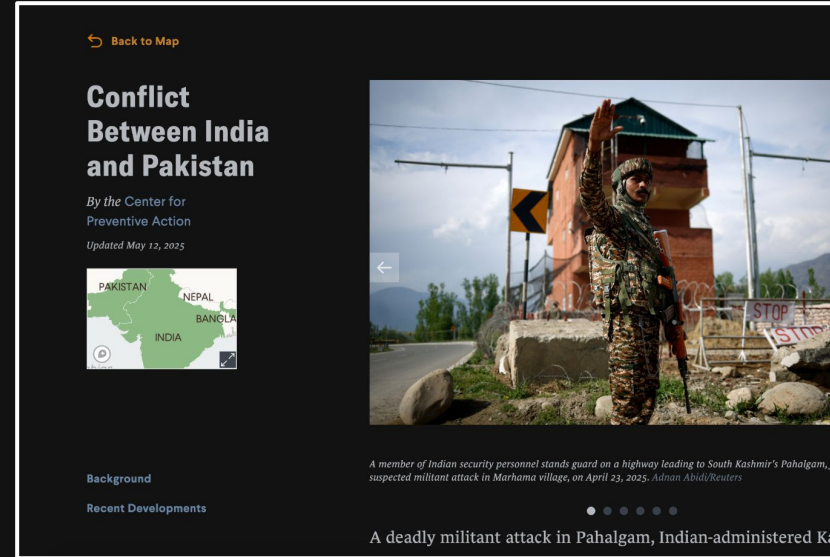
- 4 out of 5 mobile users did not notice the Latest News module—instead scrolled down to Recent Developments
 - Module was hidden on desktop

Dates are important to users

- 4 out of 10 noted it would be nice to highlight years or make them stand out

Users found the content important, but wanted more visuals

- All users get their some information on events from social media (TikTok, Instagram Reels)
- Want for more pictures, videos, interactive items on the page



Design Recommendations

Design Recommendations

More information on the homepage: provide more data and information on conflicts right on the homepage for users who are browsing.

Visually engaging content on conflict pages: more recent images, videos, timeline, interactive graphics. Break up content to be more digestible.

Improve search and filter: make these tools more prominent and improve their functionality.

Surface Latest News across the board: ensure users can't miss the most recent updates for a conflict.

Contextualize conflicts: help users understand conflicts at a macro level, visualizing key trends.

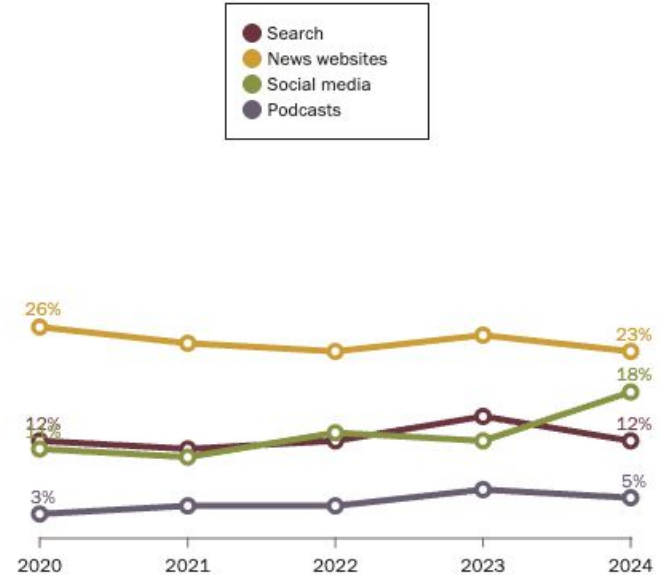
Audience Recommendations

Meet users where they are.

1. Develop a multipronged off-platform strategy to deliver updates about conflicts where users are already getting information passively.

Digital news platform preferences

% of U.S. adults who **prefer** ____ for getting news



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted July 15-Aug. 4, 2024.

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

Audience Recommendations

Meet users where they are.

2. Prioritize SEO strategy to ensure we retain and build on organic traffic

Consider the future of search behavior with AI

News platform use	Digital news platform use			
	News websites or apps	Social media	Search	Podcasts
% of U.S. adults in each demographic group who get news at least sometimes from ...				
Total	66%	54%	66%	27%
Men	68	49	65	30
Women	64	59	66	24
Ages 18-29	62	78	74	34
30-49	70	64	70	34
50-64	71	45	65	23
65+	56	28	53	14

Audience Recommendations

Create pathways for returning. Once a user learns what GCT does, how can we create a low-commitment, low-obstacle path for them to stay connected?

- Newsletter options
- Follow on social
- ???

Next Steps

Next Steps

- Personas + Audience Strategy
- Wireframes + Content
- Design + Test
- Build + Launch

Thank you!